good deal. Then I obtained as many coupons as I could from friends, family, and the coupon bin at the library. When there were limits on the amount of coupons each consumer could double, I brought my husband with me so I could have double the fun. And then I proceeded through the store aisles tossing those products that would be free or nearly free into my cart and matching those products up with the coupons from my carefully-organized box. By trip's end, I was leaving the store with a cartload of merchandise, upwards of 250 dollars worth, for less than 25 dollars. What the store was left with was empty spaces on their shelves and a register full of coupons that were worth half of the discount they gave me. Occasionally, I impulsively bought some items I didn't have a coupon for, but if the intention of the double coupon promotion was to get customers inside the store who would buy more than what they could get for cheap or for free with their coupons, then at least for me, their promotion failed miserably. Which makes one wonder why a store would continue to offer this kind of promotion? Unless, of course, only a few shoppers took advantage of the promotion to this degree, and the majority of consumers did, indeed, fill their carts with other supplies while they were inside the store.

That's exactly what happens, according to researchers Debabrata Talukdar and Dinesh K. Gauri. The results of their study were featured in a 2008 *Journal of Marketing Research*. Their research showed that only 1.2 percent of shoppers constitute the extreme "cherry pickers" and they only reduce profits less than one percent, suggesting that store managers who actually fear the cherry pickers are overestimating their effect on the bottom line profits. And if the results of recent studies are a reliable indicator of